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Digital Business

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smart Business

Playing Mailman

Most businesses today rely heavily on e-mail—reason enough for e-mail correspondence to be handled exclusively by professionals

Robert Sovereign-Smith

With the increase in Internet penetration in India, more and more businesses are using e-mail to communicate with their customers, and even their own employees and branch offices.

Whether it's complaints, feedback, placing orders with distributors, or even communicating amongst employees, e-mail has become the *de facto* form of communication today. Honestly, we don't even think much about it anymore—unless you are the systems administrator, or the one paying the bills!

The Dilemma

Unfortunately, many smaller companies are still relying on their VSNL/BSNL, Rediffmail and Gmail accounts to communicate with clients and colleagues. Some firms have their own domains, and have even set up Web sites, but are still using popular free e-mail services to conduct their business.

Today, when prices for all things online have fallen drastically, there's no excuse for not having a "yourname@yourdomain.com" e-mail id.

For instance, doesn't it look very unprofessional when you visit a Web site, check out the products on offer, decide you like them, and then have to write to some free e-mail address in order to get more information?